Contributors to adolescent overweight/obesity	Adolescent behavior objective
Excessive TV, video, computer and mobile phone use	Limit the use of TV, computer and mobile phones to 1-2 hours per day and increase outdoor activities instead
Lack of physical activity	Increase daily active play and other outdoor fun activities. one hour of active play every day is recommended as part of a healthy lifestyle.
Over consumption of sugar sweetened beverages	Replace sugar sweetened beverages such as soda, carbonated drinks and soft drinks with water, tender coconut water, fresh fruit juices (without sugar) and butter milk
Large portion sizes	Eat small meals and reduce portion sizes of foods
High consumption of fast foods and junk foods	Eat fast foods no more than 1-2 times per week. Replace junk foods with healthier eating options
Skipping breakfast.	Eat a healthy breakfast daily. If in a hurry to go to school pack your breakfast and eat it on the way.
High consumption of fatty foods	Avoid deep fat fried items and increase the intake of steamed and boiled foods
Low fibre intake in the diet	Consume 3- 4 cups of fruits and vegetables every day. Consume whole grains and pulses whenever possible.

Nutritional Anaemia

Iron deficiency anemia is a major nutritional problem in adolescent boys and girls in India. The need for iron increases with rapid growth and expansion of blood volume and muscle mass. As boys gain lean body mass at a faster rate than girls, they require more iron than girls. The onset of menstruation imposes additional needs for girls.

Main causes of Anaemia

- Inadequate iron intake/absorption/stores
- Frequent dieting or restricted eating
- Meal skipping
- Substance abuse
- Heavy/lengthy menstrual periods
- Rapid growth
- Adolescent Pregnancy
- Parasitic infection

Signs and symptom

- Fatigue, lethargy, dizziness, headaches
- Shortness of breath, ringing in ears, taste disturbances
- Restless leg syndrome
- Pallor, Flattened, brittle nails (spoon nail)
- Angular stomatitis (cracks at mouth corners)
- Glossitis, Blue sclera (whites of eyes), Pale conjunctivae.



Fig. 3.8 Signs and symptoms of Iron Deficiency

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